# Mississippi

## Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

April 3, 2026

# 1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The State of Mississippi is currently navigating a profound and highly orchestrated transition within its enterprise technology landscape, moving aggressively from a historically decentralized, agency-siloed operational model toward a unified, enterprise-wide service delivery architecture. Operating within a politically conservative climate characterized by a legislative supermajority and an executive branch heavily focused on fiscal efficiency, rural equity, and economic development, the state is leveraging historic federal funding influxes to execute generational modernization efforts. The macroeconomic environment in Mississippi is defined by a total state budget of $31.65 billion for Fiscal Year (FY) 2025, which encompasses a massive infusion of federal grants, including the American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) and the State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP).[1]

Politically, technology procurement and strategic planning are heavily centralized under the Mississippi Department of Information Technology Services (ITS), guided by the sweeping mandates of Governor Tate Reeves and the legislative oversight of the House and Senate Technology and Appropriations committees.[5] The current administrative climate is explicitly hostile toward the legacy "us versus them" mentality that has long defined the relationship between individual state agencies and the central IT authority.[10] Driven by highly publicized ransomware incidents—such as the recent attack on the University of Mississippi Medical Center—and mounting frustrations over decade-long software procurement cycles, the state legislature and ITS leadership are forcing agencies to adopt shared platforms, enterprise-level master contracts, and standardized cybersecurity perimeters.[10]

For the current fiscal year, the top administrative goals driving enterprise technology investments across the State of Mississippi revolve around four central pillars. The first is public safety and cyber resilience, prioritizing the expansion of the Capitol Complex fiber network, the fortification of the enterprise state network against denial-of-service and intrusion events, and the prevention of future ransomware disruptions.[11] The second pillar is digital equity and rural healthcare transformation, backed by a monumental $206 million grant from the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) aimed at expanding telehealth infrastructure, interoperable Electronic Health Records (EHR), and health information exchanges across underserved geographies.[13] The third pillar focuses on the modernization of legacy administrative systems, specifically targeting the Department of Human Services and the Division of Medicaid to replace disparate, twenty-five-year-old case management and eligibility systems that currently fail to meet federal data interoperability standards.[10] Finally, the fourth pillar centers on the responsible adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and digital government services, marked by the creation of the Artificial Intelligence Regulation (AIR) Task Force, the launch of an AI Innovation Hub, and the implementation of a comprehensive AI Acceptable Use Policy.[17]

For enterprise technology providers like Dell Technologies, Mississippi presents an incredibly lucrative, yet structurally complex, battlefield. The state's evolving "cloud-right" infrastructure

strategy does not equate to a wholesale public cloud migration; rather, the state is investing heavily in expanding its on-premises private cloud capabilities within the Primary Data Center and the Co-Processing Data Center.[11] This hybrid approach, combined with the stringent data privacy requirements of the newly established AI governance frameworks, creates immense whitespace for Dell's on-premises infrastructure, edge computing architectures, client solutions, and advisory services.

## 2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological power structure in Mississippi is federated but highly interdependent. Successful vendor engagement requires navigating a complex triad of stakeholders: the elected leadership that controls the statutory authorization and appropriations, the central IT leadership that dictates architectural standards and procurement mechanisms, and the agency-level leadership that possesses the functional business requirements and the actual project capital. ITS serves as the mandatory gateway for any technology acquisition exceeding specific dollar thresholds, but the individual agencies act as the ultimate consumers and financial sponsors of the technology.

The following table categorizes the key individuals shaping the state's technology procurement and policy landscape:

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology & Procurement |
|---|---|---|
| **Tate Reeves**<br><br>Governor, State of Mississippi | **Elected Leadership**<br><br>(Executive Mandates & Veto Power) | Issued Executive Order 1584 directing ITS to harness AI and establish statewide governance. Secured the $206M CMS grant to fundamentally transform rural healthcare technology infrastructure.[13] |
| **Dr. Craig P. Orgeron**<br><br>Executive Director & State CIO, ITS | **IT Leadership**<br><br>(Central Technical Authority) | Vocally advocates for ending agency-siloed mentalities. Pushing aggressively for enterprise-level contracts, shared systems, and procurement reforms to shave years off modernization timelines.[10] |

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology & Procurement |
|---|---|---|
| **Jay White**<br><br>Chief Information Security Officer, ITS | **IT Leadership**<br><br>(Security Architect & Influencer) | Focuses heavily on centralized, enterprise-wide approaches to information security to ensure cost-effective controls. Manages the Enterprise Security Program securing the state data centers.[11] |
| **W. Briggs Hopson III**<br><br>Chairman, Senate Appropriations Committee | **Elected Leadership**<br><br>(Financial Purchaser/Approver) | Central figure in overseeing the distribution of the state's budget. He is currently navigating a highly constrained $7.36 billion state budget environment where Medicaid costs exceed $1 billion annually, increasing the pressure for cost-saving IT consolidations. |
| **John Read**<br><br>Chairman, House Appropriations A Committee | **Elected Leadership**<br><br>(Financial Purchaser/Approver) | Key gatekeeper for agency-level operational and capital funding requests. Oversees budget allocations for public safety, human services, and massive IT infrastructure reappropriations amidst a highly constrained broader state budget. |
| **Bart Williams**<br><br>Chairman, Senate Technology Committee & Co-Chair, AIR Task Force | **Elected Leadership**<br><br>(Legislative IT Policy) | Champions responsible AI adoption that balances operational benefits with citizen data privacy. Co-authored the Artificial Intelligence Regulation (AIR) Task Force legislation.[9] |

| Name & Title | Sphere of Influence | Recent Public Stances on Technology & Procurement |
|---|---|---|
| **Jill Ford**<br><br>Chairman, House Technology Committee & Co-Chair, AIR Task Force | **Elected Leadership**<br><br>(Legislative IT Policy) | Co-leads legislative IT oversight. Recently defended legislation on the House floor to codify the state's definition of AI, assuring businesses that these regulations are designed to provide safety without hindering economic investment. |
| **Christa L. Alexander**<br><br>Chair, ITS Board | **IT Leadership**<br><br>(Contract Approver/Governance) | Oversees the formal approval of all major ITS procurements, vendor contract negotiations, and Express Products List (EPL) awards, ensuring maximum competition and compliance.[25] |
| **Sean Tindell**<br><br>Commissioner, Department of Public Safety (DPS) | **Agency Leadership**<br><br>(Financial Purchaser/Consumer) | Presented massive budget requests to the legislature, including $50M for law enforcement training facility modernization and millions to expand Capitol Police technology footprints.[12] |
| **Andrea Sanders**<br><br>Commissioner, Child Protection Services (CPS) | **Agency Leadership**<br><br>(Financial Purchaser/Consumer) | Highly critical of the state's slow IT procurement processes and low-bidder vendor tactics. Actively managing the replacement of a 25-year-old case management system that predates smartphones.[10] |

The dynamics between these stakeholders reveal significant friction points that savvy technology vendors can exploit. Agency commissioners like Andrea Sanders are openly frustrated by the state's historical procurement practices, noting that aggressive bidding strategies by vendors—who submit unrealistic timelines and lowest-bid pricing—have resulted in multi-year project delays.[10] CIO Craig Orgeron is leveraging this exact frustration to mandate the adoption of enterprise shared services, arguing that unified systems will save millions of dollars and accelerate deployment timelines.[10] For a vendor, this means that while the technical sale must be validated by Orgeron and White at ITS to ensure architectural compliance, the emotional and programmatic sale must be won at the agency level, promising commissioners

accelerated deployment, risk mitigation, and immediate operational relief.

# 3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

The State of Mississippi operates under a complex, statutorily defined IT governance framework that dictates every aspect of technology acquisition, deployment, and management. Over the past five years, this framework has undergone a deliberate evolution, shifting the state's operational posture and fundamentally altering how vendors must structure their financial proposals and technical architectures.

## Operating Model: The Transition from Federated to Hybrid

Historically, Mississippi's IT delivery was highly federated. Individual agencies maintained isolated data centers, procured proprietary software, and managed independent IT budgets with little regard for statewide interoperability.[11] However, recognizing the severe financial inefficiencies and escalating cybersecurity vulnerabilities inherent in this decentralized approach, the Mississippi Legislature empowered ITS to drive a hybrid consolidation strategy. Today, ITS acts as the central catalyst and governance authority, while agencies retain operational ownership of their specific programmatic applications.[5]

This hybrid model is anchored by the Mississippi Cloud Ecosystem. ITS operates a highly resilient enterprise private cloud spread across two primary locations: the Primary Data Center (PDC) and the Co-Processing Data Center (CPDC).[11] The PDC provides over 12,000 square feet of hardened raised-floor space designed for mission-critical enterprise mainframe and open-systems hosting, while the CPDC provides geographic redundancy for disaster recovery and business continuity.[20] Rather than mandating a "cloud-only" policy that forces all workloads into hyperscaler environments, ITS has adopted a pragmatic "cloud-right" strategy.[20] This strategy emphasizes standardizing IT hardware through enterprise architecture, maximizing the utilization of the state's on-premises private cloud investments, and establishing secure, centralized network access to major public cloud providers solely when cost-effective and compliant.[11]

## Friction Points and the Chargeback Mechanisms

The transition toward a hybrid, consolidated enterprise is a massive change-management exercise, generating significant operational friction. Currently, much of the IT expenditure remains directly allocated to individual agencies, affording them vast discretion over spending decisions and creating an environment where ITS must constantly lobby for agency buy-in to sustain enterprise infrastructure.[11]

To formalize this relationship, the legislature instituted a unique "Hub and Spoke" financial model via Senate Bill 2779.[27]

- **The Hub (Core Services):** ITS receives a direct General Fund appropriation to support its core business functions, strategic planning, and the foundational development of shared

enterprise technology infrastructure.[30]

- **The Spoke (Consumption Services):** State agencies consume these shared services—such as telecommunications, data center compute, storage, and disaster recovery—and pay for them using their own appropriated federal or special funds. ITS utilizes the ITS Revolving Fund to pass through these actual contractual costs directly to the consuming agencies.[27]

This chargeback model is the primary friction point regarding how individual agencies procure IT services from the central IT authority. Agencies are acutely aware of the costs passed down from ITS, creating tension when centralized mandates force agencies to abandon bespoke legacy systems for shared platforms. Furthermore, the governance model imposes strict E-Government Transaction fees (EOC Fees) on digital applications. Any application that accepts electronic payments is subject to a processing fee, and the state collects a 2% cut of net operating profits from portal vendors to fund the operations of the central ms.gov portal.[31] Vendors proposing Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) or digital citizen platforms must meticulously account for these EOC chargebacks within their pricing models to ensure their solutions remain financially viable for the purchasing agency.

The overarching operational friction point, however, remains the procurement timeline. With agency leaders testifying that system upgrades routinely stretch close to a decade due to complex RFP processes and vendor underperformance, there is intense pressure across all branches of government to leverage pre-competed purchasing vehicles and managed service models that guarantee rapid deployment and predictable operational expenditures (OPEX).[10]

# 4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Navigating the financial landscape of the State of Mississippi requires an understanding of the state's legislative appropriation cycles, the boundaries of its fiscal year, and the massive, targeted influxes of federal grant funding that supplement standard tax revenues.

## Total & IT Budget Architecture

The State of Mississippi operates on a fiscal year that begins on July 1 and ends on June 30.[33] This boundary is critical for technology vendors, as budget flush spending typically occurs in late spring (April and May), while new capital deployment cycles align with the July 1 budget activation.

For Fiscal Year 2025, the total state budget authorized by the legislature stands at an impressive $31,651,974,218.[2] This total is aggregated from three primary funding streams: $7.03 billion in State General Funds, $13.19 billion in Federal Funds, and $8.74 billion in Other Special Funds.[2]

Due to the federated nature of the Spoke funding model, the state does not publish a single, consolidated "Statewide IT Budget" within its legislative bulletins. Therefore, explicitly regarding the distinct categorization of recurring operational spend (O&M) versus net-new

project/capital investments for massive individual agencies like the Division of Medicaid or the Department of Transportation, exact financial numbers are Data Unavailable.[2] However, the central IT authority, the Department of Information Technology Services (ITS), received a specific FY 2025 General Fund appropriation of $26,715,410 to fund the "Hub" infrastructure and operations, alongside an additional $3.7 million in Capital Expense Funds designated specifically for IT upgrades, including core network and security refreshes.[2]

While centralized line items for agency IT are opaque, the legislative budget bulletin outlines several significant reappropriations for net-new project capital investments that highlight the state's modernization priorities:

- **Department of Child Protection Services:** $6,789,259 reappropriated specifically for "Information Technology System Developments" to support the replacement of their legacy case management software.[2]
- **Secretary of State:** $1,200,000 designated for the "Mississippi Voting Modernization Act".[2]
- **Supreme Court:** $310,000 for IT Equipment and Youth Court Computers, and $362,686 for the MEC System.[2]
- **Department of Public Safety:** $54.2 million for a new headquarters building, which will entail massive net-new networking, cabling, and endpoint deployments.[2]

Looking ahead to the FY 2026 budget cycle, ITS has submitted aggressive funding requests aimed at standardizing enterprise architecture. These requests focus heavily on modernizing statewide disaster recovery solutions to ensure expedient restoration of services, expanding the capabilities of the Capitol Complex Fiber Network (replacing end-of-life equipment to support up to 10 Gbps bandwidth across 50 state buildings), and implementing centralized cybersecurity perimeter tools, including advanced firewalls and threat intelligence feeds.[11]

## Grants & Major Funding Influxes

The baseline state budget is heavily augmented by major influxes of federal and state grant dollars explicitly applicable to technology modernization. These grants act as powerful catalysts, allowing agencies to bypass standard budget constraints and execute massive capital deployments:

- **Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP):** In a landmark award, the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) granted Mississippi $205,907,220.[13] This funding is exclusively dedicated to strengthening rural healthcare through digital transformation. The mandate includes expanding telehealth adoption, upgrading interoperable EHR systems, and building robust health information exchanges over the next five years.[14]
- **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP):** Administered by the Mississippi Office of Homeland Security, the state has been allocated $1,625,367 for FY 2025 to strengthen the cybersecurity resilience of state and local government information systems.[3] Crucially, the state anticipates covering all matching funds with soft

match amounts, allowing local entities to adopt cybersecurity technologies without incurring a direct cost burden.[3]

- **American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA):** Mississippi received over $1.8 billion in State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds (SLFRF). While significant portions were deployed for water and HVAC infrastructure, tens of millions of dollars continue to be funneled into mitigating backlogs in the judicial system, autopsy laboratories, and workforce development, all of which require underlying data management and compute infrastructure.[4]

# 5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects

Mississippi's transition toward an enterprise-centric technology model is driven by several massive, multi-year strategic initiatives. The following represent the top funded modernization efforts across the entity, detailing the executive mandates, the owning agencies, and the underlying IT requirements.

## 1. Project SUCCESS (System to Uphold Comprehensive Care and Eligibility for State Services)

- **The Executive Mandate:** Driven by strict federal compliance mandates and the state's strategic goal to optimize citizen services, Project SUCCESS aims to completely eradicate aging legacy infrastructure that hampers the delivery of vital social programs.[15] The mandate requires the consolidation of fragmented databases to provide a holistic, unified view of citizen eligibility and benefits, ensuring compliance with federal rules such as the FNS 901 Handbook.[38]
- **The High-Spend Agency:** The Mississippi Department of Human Services (MDHS) and the Division of Medicaid.[15]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** Following a complex procurement process (RFP 4488), the integration contract was awarded to Deloitte Consulting LLP for a staggering five-year lifecycle cost of $195,383,260.[39] The technical requirements for this project are immense. The initiative involves replacing five distinct legacy IT systems—handling the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF), Child Care Payment Program, and Child Support Enforcement—with a single modernized platform.[16] From an infrastructure perspective, this mandates the deployment of a highly scalable Cloud-Based Operational Data Store (ODS).[15] The state explicitly requires comprehensive capacity planning for operational memory and data storage, a massive data conversion and migration effort from legacy mainframes, and the strict physical and logical separation of production and test data.[38] Furthermore, MDHS requires a "skeleton structure" repository for historical data retention, creating a continuous need for scalable, long-term object or block storage architectures.[38]

## 2. Rural Health Transformation and Digital Equity

- **The Executive Mandate:** Governor Tate Reeves's sweeping "Make Rural America Healthy

Again" initiative, designed to close severe regional care gaps, ensure sustainable access to specialized medicine, and foster digital equity across Mississippi's dispersed rural populations.[40]

- **The High-Spend Agency:** The Mississippi Division of Medicaid, working in close conjunction with the Mississippi State Department of Health (MSDH) and the Office of the Governor.[13]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** Fueled entirely by the recent $206 million CMS grant, this initiative is highly dependent on the rapid deployment of edge technology and robust networking infrastructure.[13] The state's comprehensive plan includes six distinct initiatives, notably the Health Technology Advancement and Modernization (HTAM) and Telehealth Adoption and Provider Support (TAPS) programs.[14] The technical requirements dictate that by Year 5, 90% of funded rural providers must have upgraded to interoperable EHR systems, and 75% must actively share data through a statewide Health Information Exchange (HIE).[14] Furthermore, the plan mandates a 40% increase in telehealth visits, requiring the widespread deployment of remote patient monitoring (RPM) systems, high-resolution diagnostic displays, mobile clinics, and ruggedized edge computing devices capable of processing health data in bandwidth-constrained rural environments.[14]

## 3. MSWIN (Mississippi Wireless Information Network) P25 System Upgrade

- **The Executive Mandate:** A non-negotiable public safety imperative to maintain 99.999% availability for the state's interoperable emergency communications network. This network is the critical lifeline for emergency responders across local, state, and federal jurisdictions, especially during natural disasters.[44]
- **The High-Spend Agency:** The Mississippi Wireless Communication Commission (MWCC) and the Department of Public Safety (DPS).[44]
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** The MSWIN infrastructure is a massive Land Mobile Radio (LMR) P25 system supporting over 69,000 subscribers and covering 97% of the state.[44] Originally built in 2009, the underlying hardware is approaching a critical 2032 end-of-life cliff where manufacturers will cease support for key operational components.[44] To avert a catastrophic communications failure, the MWCC has submitted an urgent budget request of $150 million to completely overhaul the system over the next decade. This includes an immediate $28 million requirement strictly to update end-of-life microwave network components.[44] Technologically, this upgrade requires highly ruggedized on-premises compute clusters, edge data centers at remote radio transmission sites, and impenetrable disaster recovery architectures to ensure zero downtime.

# 6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

Selling into the State of Mississippi requires mastering a highly structured, centralized procurement methodology governed by ITS. Vendors must navigate specific contract vehicles, contend with deeply entrenched incumbents, and ensure absolute adherence to a rapidly evolving matrix of cybersecurity and AI governance mandates.

## Procurement Vehicles & Preferred Purchasing Methods

ITS controls the primary avenues for technology acquisition, dictating how agencies spend their allocated capital. For routine hardware and software procurement, the state relies heavily on **Express Products Lists (EPLs)**. The most critical vehicle for enterprise infrastructure vendors is the **IT Hardware EPL 3760** (also referenced under EPO 4671).[47]

- **EPL Mechanics:** This instrument utilizes a Manufacturer-Sponsored Reseller Group model. Technology manufacturers publish approved product catalogs with "not-to-exceed" pricing, and designated resellers execute the final transactions.[49]
- **Purchasing Limits:** The standard purchase limit is $200,000 per project, per fiscal year. However, for specific enterprise IT hardware categories, the threshold extends up to $500,000 without requiring additional authorization from the ITS Board.[47]
- **The CP-1 Process:** Any project that exceeds these dollar thresholds or involves complex software integrations must undergo the formal CP-1 Acquisition Approval process, which often requires a full RFP and direct presentation to the ITS Board for approval.[25]
- **Cooperative Agreements:** Beyond EPLs, ITS actively facilitates purchases through national cooperative agreements, most notably utilizing NASPO ValuePoint for software value-added resellers and specific cloud solutions.[48]

## The Battlefield: Vendor Footprints and Legacy Infrastructure

The competitive landscape in Mississippi is defined by entrenched incumbents holding massive legacy contracts, alongside aging infrastructure that creates immense vulnerabilities and modernization opportunities.

- **Compute, Storage, and Hardware:** Dell Technologies maintains a dominant incumbent footprint on EPL 3760, supported by a vast network of authorized regional resellers, including SHI International, Zones, Synergetics, and Mainstream Technologies.[55] Dell's footprint is further evidenced by recent ITS Board approvals, such as a $356,873 supplement awarded to Dell Marketing, L.P. specifically for Microsoft Unified Support.[57] Competitors such as Cisco and Panasonic also maintain active profiles on the hardware EPLs.[51]
- **Systems Integration and ERP:** In the software integration space, Deloitte is deeply entrenched, having just secured the $195 million MDHS SUCCESS contract.[39] Workday maintains a massive footprint in higher education and healthcare, operating a $28 million lifecycle ERP deployment at the University of Mississippi Medical Center.[59]

- **Public Safety and Communications:** Motorola Solutions holds a near-monopoly on the Public Safety Video and Communications (PSVC) sector. They manage the foundational LMR network for MSWIN and recently secured a $5.3 million contract for body-worn and in-car cameras for the Department of Public Safety.[59]
- **Aging Infrastructure Ripe for Rip-and-Replace:** Despite these entrenched players, agency operations are severely hindered by legacy technical debt. Agencies like Child Protection Services have explicitly stated they are operating on systems that predate smartphones, waiting years for procurements to clear.[10] Similarly, the drive by ITS to maximize utilization of the Primary Data Center reveals that numerous agencies are still operating vulnerable, inefficient "server closet" infrastructure that is highly susceptible to hardware failure and ransomware, creating prime targets for hardware refresh and consolidation campaigns.[11]

## Compliance and Regulatory Drivers

Technology architectures proposed to the State of Mississippi must strictly adhere to an evolving matrix of state and federal regulations:

- **StateRAMP:** As Mississippi modernizes its hybrid cloud ecosystem, it has officially adopted StateRAMP. This framework is used to vet cloud service providers, ensuring that any off-premises infrastructure meets stringent cybersecurity certifications prior to touching state data.[60]
- **AI Governance Mandates:** Mississippi is establishing itself as a national pioneer in state-level AI regulation. Governor Reeves issued Executive Order 1584, and the legislature passed SB 2426 creating the Artificial Intelligence Regulation (AIR) Task Force.[17] ITS has published a strict AI Acceptable Use Policy that mandates absolute human oversight for all AI-supported decisions, protects confidential information from being ingested into public Large Language Models (LLMs), and strictly forbids high-risk AI activities without centralized approval.[18]
- **Cloud Center of Excellence (CCOE):** The recently passed "Cloud Center of Excellence Act" (House Bill 1491) establishes the CCOE within ITS to dictate statewide best practices for cloud migration. This framework mandates a phased, two-year implementation for cloud migration and optimization standards across all state agencies and local governing authorities, requiring them to systematically prove security, scalability, and cost efficiency.
- **Federal Compliance:** All infrastructure handling public safety data must comply with Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) mandates.[61] Massive social services and healthcare projects like MDHS SUCCESS and RHTP must adhere to HIPAA regulations and the stringent data protection guidelines of the FNS 901 Handbook.[38]

# 7. Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on the strategic mandates, massive financial inflows, and existing operational friction points within the State of Mississippi, the following highly actionable sales motions are recommended for Dell Technologies:

- **Funded Alignment: MDHS SUCCESS Data Consolidation & CPDC Expansion** The $195 million MDHS SUCCESS modernization project is bound by strict federal requirements for massive data conversion, target system load capacity planning, and the absolute segregation of production and test data.[38] Dell must aggressively position its **PowerStore and PowerEdge platforms** to both ITS leadership and Deloitte as the foundational, high-performance architecture for this initiative. Concurrently, as ITS seeks legislative funding to expand the disaster recovery capabilities of the Co-Processing Data Center (CPDC) and the Capitol Complex Fiber Network [11], Dell can leverage **Dell APEX Custom Solutions**. By offering IT infrastructure as a service, Dell allows ITS to shift from a massive Capital Expense (CAPEX) request to a predictable Operational Expense (OPEX) model, perfectly aligning with the state's new "Hub and Spoke" financial chargeback mechanisms and mitigating agency friction over high shared-service costs.[20]
- **Whitespace & Advisory: MDOC Advanced Data Analytics Pilot**
  The Mississippi Department of Corrections (MDOC) is facing severe challenges with staffing shortages and safety risks. In response, the legislature has authorized a pilot project (House Bill 1747) utilizing advanced data analytics and decision-support technology to predict and mitigate these risks without increasing headcount. This initiative represents an ideal whitespace for Dell. Account teams should immediately target MDOC leadership to position **Dell's edge computing, AI-ready infrastructure, and data analytics portfolio** as the foundational architecture to support this critical predictive intelligence and act as a force multiplier for correctional staff.
- **Funded Alignment: Rural Health Edge & Client Modernization** The $206 million CMS Rural Health Transformation Program is explicitly designed to deploy remote patient monitoring, expand telehealth capacity by 40%, and stand up interoperable EHR systems across remote, underserved environments.[14] This initiative represents a massive, fully funded pipeline for **Dell Client Solutions**. Dell account executives should immediately target the Division of Medicaid and the State Department of Health to position ruggedized Latitude tablets, OptiPlex micro-form-factor endpoints, and high-resolution diagnostic displays for virtual nursing stations and mobile clinics. Furthermore, Dell can position **Dell Edge Server infrastructure (PowerEdge XR series)** to provide localized, ruggedized compute capabilities at rural healthcare hubs. This ensures high-speed data processing and continuous uptime for the statewide Health Information Exchange (HIE), even in geographical corridors where broadband connectivity remains inconsistent.
- **Whitespace & Advisory: Sovereign AI and On-Premises Generative AI Governance**
  Mississippi's highly aggressive posture on AI regulation—spearheaded by the AIR Task Force, the ITS AI Innovation Hub, and the remarkably strict AI Acceptable Use

Policy—creates a unique, high-margin advisory whitespace.[17] Dell's advisory teams should leverage Representative Jill Ford's recent legislative momentum in codifying AI definitions on the House floor, engaging her and other state leaders on safe, sovereign AI architectures that protect citizen data without hindering economic investment. By positioning private, sovereign AI infrastructure hosted entirely within the state's Primary Data Center or the new MSU High-Performance Computing Data Center [62], Dell can guarantee the ITS CISO that Mississippi can harness advanced AI innovation without compromising data sovereignty or violating CJIS, HIPAA, or FNS compliance requirements.

- **Competitive Displacement: Cloud Repatriation and Legacy "Server Closet" Rip-and-Replace** With appropriators like Senate Appropriations Chairman Briggs Hopson navigating a constrained $7.36 billion state budget where Medicaid costs currently exceed $1 billion annually, Dell's APEX consumption models and cost-saving consolidation strategies are urgently needed. Agency commissioners have publicly testified to their deep frustration with decade-long IT implementations and the hidden, escalating costs of maintaining siloed, 25-year-old operational systems.[10] By executing a rip-and-replace of isolated agency hardware and migrating those workloads onto a Dell-backed ITS private cloud environment, Dell enables individual agencies to drastically lower their total cost of ownership. Crucially, by utilizing the **IT Hardware EPL 3760**, Dell account teams and their authorized resellers can execute these hardware refresh motions swiftly for sub-$500k tactical interventions [52], completely bypassing the multi-year RFP delays that have historically paralyzed Mississippi's modernization efforts.

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